

SAFE SPACES

Preparing Your Home for a Pet

Use this guide to create a safer, calmer environment before your adopted pet comes home.

Create a settling-in area

- Choose one quiet area where the pet can eat, drink, rest, and decompress without constant traffic.
- Keep the first setup predictable. Avoid moving beds, bowls, litter boxes, or enclosures repeatedly during the first few days.
- Give the pet a place to retreat. Do not force interaction when they choose to rest or hide.

Pet-proof the environment

- Move medicines, cleaning products, sharp objects, cords, small swallowable items, and unsafe foods out of reach.
- Check windows, balconies, gates, fences, doors, and screens for escape risks.
- Protect plants or household items that may be unsafe for the species you are adopting.
- Introduce access to the home gradually instead of opening every room immediately.

Prepare the household

- Agree on feeding, exercise, cleaning, and training responsibilities before the pet arrives.
- Explain calm handling and boundaries to children before introductions.
- If you already have pets, plan slow introductions and separate resources at first.
- Keep the first days quiet and avoid turning the arrival into a large gathering.

Every animal is different

Use the rescue team's guidance for the individual pet. Their history, age, species, confidence level, and household needs may change how quickly you introduce new spaces or routines.